

RESIDENTIAL CONVEYANCING · EFFICIENT, TRANSPARENT, RELIABLE

The Property Transfer Process

From the moment an Offer to Purchase is signed, eleven distinct stages unfold before a property is registered in your name. This guide sets out each phase clearly — what happens, who acts and what we ask of you — so you can navigate the transfer with confidence.

PHASE I INSTRUCTION & COMPLIANCE

STEPS 1–3

- 01 Receive Instruction**
We receive the signed Offer to Purchase, open the transfer file, appoint a conveyancer and confirm instruction in writing with all parties.
- 02 Contact All Parties · Collect FICA**
We engage the seller, purchaser and estate agent to collect FICA documentation — identity, proof of residence and SARS tax numbers.
- 03 Obtain Bond Cancellation Figures**
Where applicable, we contact the seller's bank to obtain bond cancellation figures and an estimated payout date for registration day.

PHASE II DOCUMENTATION & CLEARANCES

STEPS 4–7

- 04 Compliance Certificates**
We co-ordinate Electrical, Electric Fence, Gas and — where applicable — Beetle and Borer compliance certificates on the seller's behalf.
- 05 Rates & Levy Clearances**
We apply to the municipality and (where relevant) the body corporate or HOA for rates and levy clearance certificates.
- 06 Payment & Guarantees**
We request transfer costs and transfer duty from the purchaser, or obtain formal guarantees from the bond registration attorneys.
- 07 Sign Transfer Documents**
We prepare all documents required under the Deeds Registries Act and attend on each party to sign — at your home, office or any agreed location.

OUR APPROACH

"Our approach is to remove uncertainty from each stage of the transfer — keeping our clients informed, in writing, every step of the way."

— DYLAN NESER · DIRECTOR & CONVEYANCER

DOCUMENTS WE'LL NEED FROM YOU

Identity	Certified copy of your ID document or passport.
Residence	Proof of address — utility bill or municipal account < 3 months old.
SARS	SARS tax number and most recent SARS notice or assessment.
Marital status	Marriage certificate and ANC, where applicable.
Title Deed	Original title deed of the property (seller). Held by the bond holder where a bond is registered.

PHASE III LODGEMENT & REGISTRATION

STEPS 8–11

- 08 Liaise with Bond & Cancellation Attorneys**
We co-ordinate timelines across all three attorney firms to ensure simultaneous lodgement at the Deeds Office.
- 09 Lodge at the Deeds Office**
Once all documents, clearances, guarantees and transfer duty receipts are in order, we lodge the complete bundle for registration.
- 10 Deeds Office Examination**
Examiners scrutinise all lodged documents. Once examination passes and queries are resolved, the file moves to "prep" — ready for registration.
- 11 Registration & Title Deed Issued**
The transfer is registered. Sale proceeds are paid to the seller, the new title deed is issued to the purchaser, and keys are handed over.

INDICATIVE TIMELINE

Standard transfer	6–10 weeks from instruction, subject to FICA compliance and clearance availability.
Deeds Office	7–10 working days for examination. Weekly written progress updates.
Mobile signing	We attend on you at home, office or any agreed location.
Request a quote	Transaction-specific cost estimate available on request.

WHAT TO EXPECT FROM US

A dedicated conveyancer assigned to your matter from instruction to registration. Weekly written progress updates. Direct access to the director throughout. Mobile signing at your convenience. A transparent pro forma account before any work begins.

FREQUENTLY ASKED

How long does a transfer take?

A standard residential transfer takes 6–10 weeks from instruction. Delays most commonly arise from outstanding rates clearances, incomplete FICA documents or delays in bond cancellation by the seller's bank.

Who appoints the conveyancer?

By convention, the seller appoints the transferring attorney. The purchaser pays the transfer costs but does not select the conveyancer. Maintain regular contact with us throughout to ensure tireless co-operation.

What about unpaid municipal charges?

The seller must obtain a rates clearance certificate from the municipality before transfer can be lodged. All outstanding rates, taxes and levies must be settled — and we typically pay ±4 months ahead to secure clearance.

Who pays for what?

The purchaser pays transfer duty, transfer attorney fees and Deeds Office registration. The seller pays bond cancellation costs, compliance certificates, rates and levy clearance, and the estate agent's commission.